RAJALAKSHMI ENGINEERING COLLEGE

THANDALAM

College Mini Project

Campus Lost and Found Management System

One database for every lost and found item on campus

Java Swing | MySQL | JDBC

Mentor	Vani B

Submitted by

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1. The Problem

Students and staff often lose ID cards, books, phones, bottles and keys on campus. Today these items are handled through notice boards, word of mouth and group messages. That is slow, unorganised and leaves no proper record. Owners cannot find their things, finders do not know whom to return them to, and nobody can verify who the real owner is.

This system solves it with one central database, search and filters, and a claim process that tracks each item until it is returned. It is a desktop application that keeps every lost and found item on campus in one database, so owners can find their belongings and claim them safely.

2. Objectives

- Keep a central record of lost and found items on campus.
- Let users add, view, update and delete item records.
- Provide keyword search and filters by report type (Lost or Found) and status (Open, Claimed, Returned).
- Let users submit claims and track them until the item is returned.
- Validate inputs and keep data correct with keys and constraints.
- Offer a simple, easy-to-use interface for non-technical users.

3. Features

Item management	Add, view, update and delete lost and found items.
Search and filters	Find items by keyword and filter them by status.
Claim workflow	Submit a claim with proof, then track it from Pending to Returned.
Secure login	Users log in with an email and password, and passwords are stored as hashes.
Dashboard	One place to navigate every screen and see item counts.
Input validation	Clear messages for empty or wrong data, so records stay clean.
MySQL database	Users, items and claims linked by primary and foreign keys.

4. System Design

The application is built in layers. The Swing screens talk to the Java logic, which uses JDBC to read and write the MySQL database.

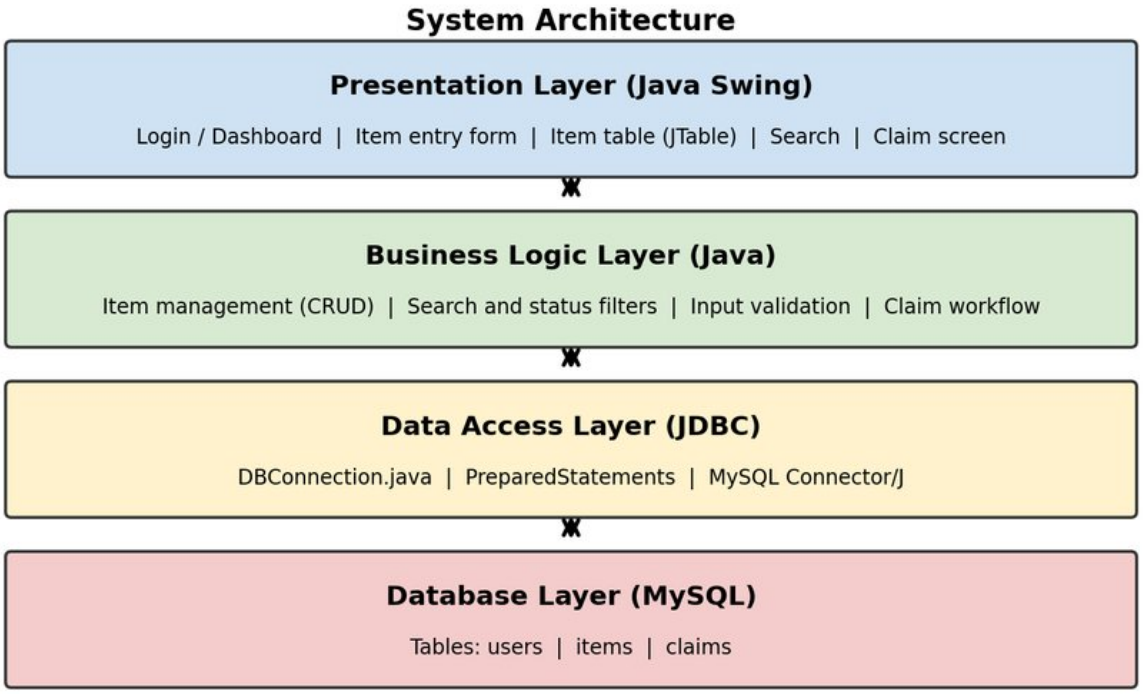


Figure 1: System architecture

5. Database Design

Three tables: users, items and claims. A user reports many items, an item can have many claims, and a user can submit and review claims.

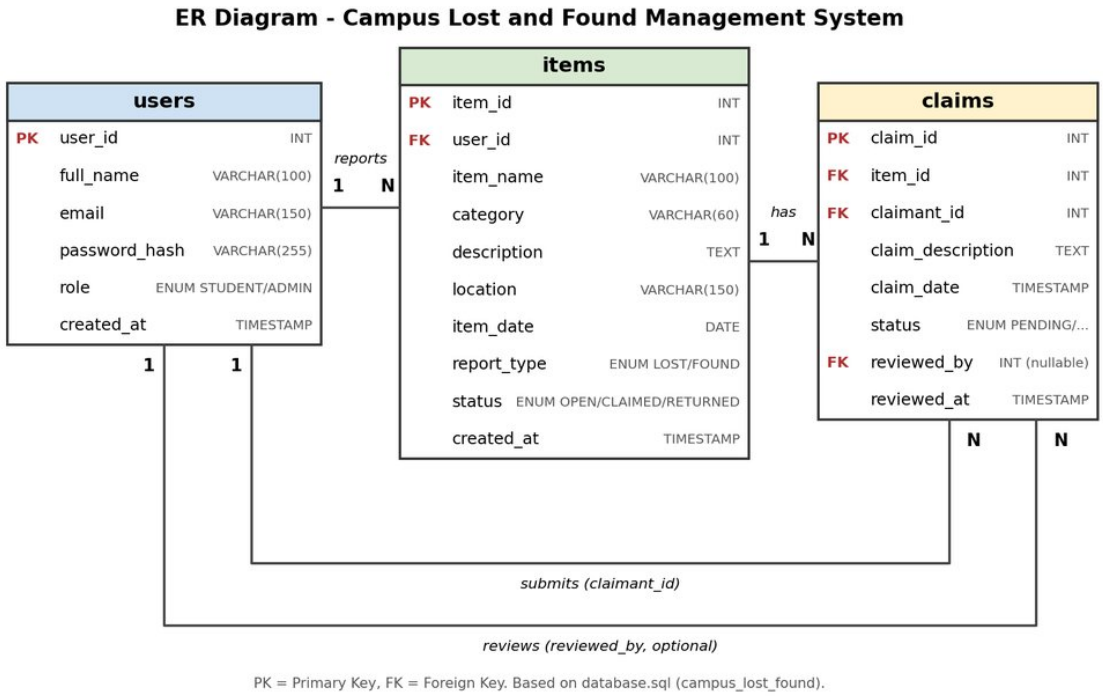


Figure 2: ER diagram (database campus_lost_found)

6. How a Claim Works

1. A user logs in and reports an item as Found (status **Open**).
2. The owner finds it in the list and submits a claim description as proof of ownership.
3. The claim stays **Pending** and the item becomes **Claimed**.
4. An administrator reviews the claim: approval marks the item **Returned**, and rejection sets it back to **Open**.

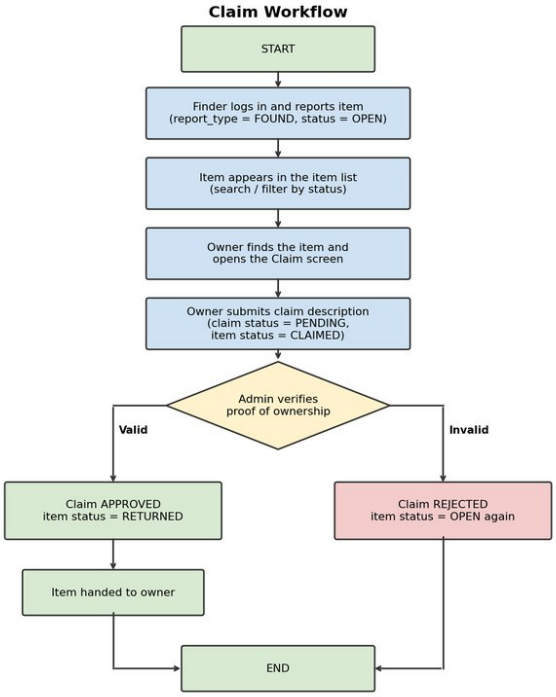


Figure 3: Claim workflow

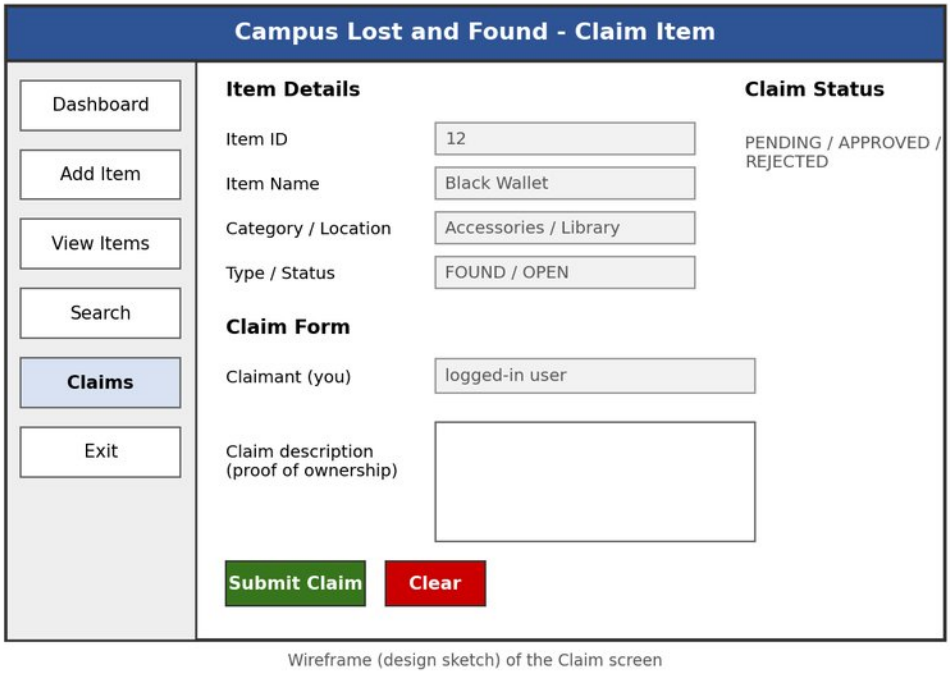


Figure 4: Claim screen design (sketch)

7. Team

Team members

Name	Register Number
Deepika P	250701133
Charulatha U	250701122
Ilakkiya S	250701873
Bavana S	250701100

Mentor: **Vani B**

Work division

Role	Responsibility
Member 1	Database and JDBC connection
Member 2	Java UI and dashboard
Member 3	CRUD operations and search
Member 4	Claims, testing and documentation

Testing and future scope

19 test cases cover the database, login, items, search, filters and claims.

- Web and mobile version
- Email or SMS alerts
- Photo upload for items